

PAKYONG AIRPORT

Sikkim

NO FLIGHTS SINCE JUNE 2024

Cost: **Rs 605 cr.**

Opened: **Sept. 24, 2018** (Udan 2.0)

Routes: **Kolkata, Guwahati, Delhi**

Highlight: Operations were suspended for the first time from **Jun. 1, 2019 to Jan. 23, 2021**

Key Issues: Despite adverse weather and limited visibility, the airport is equipped solely with visual navigation aids

UDAN AT A GLANCE

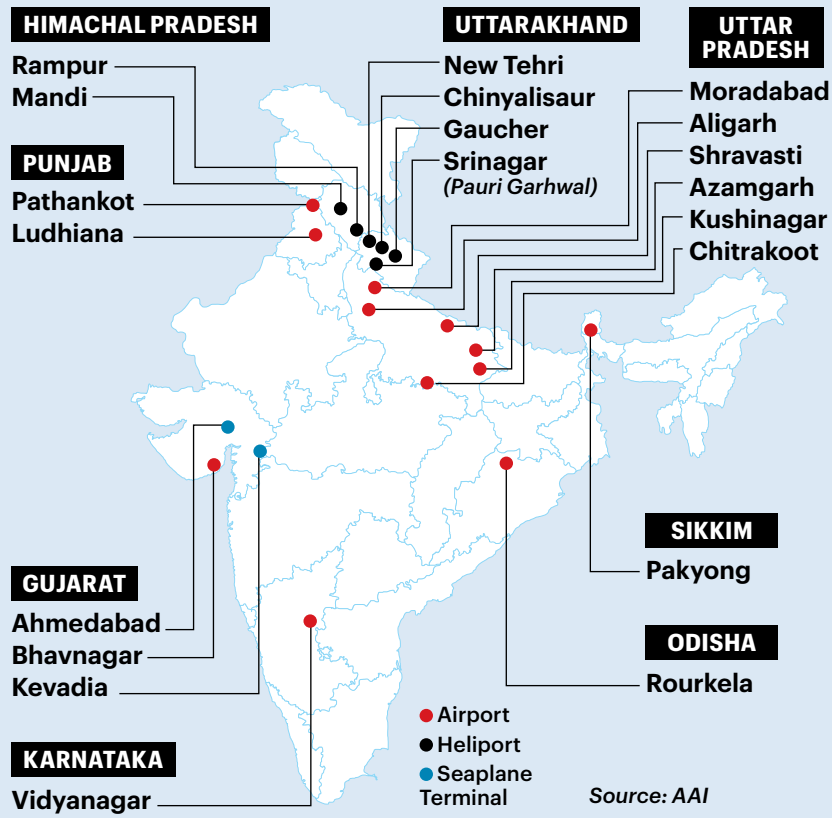
Launched in 2016 to connect Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities through affordable air routes

Rs 4,638 cr. invested to develop or revive 93 airports, heliports, etc. on 649 routes so far

20 airports or 22% of the total 93 Udan airports have been tagged 'non-operational' by the AAI

Rs 1,089 cr. spent on Udan airports that never opened or closed prematurely, as per the CAG's 2023 estimates

NON-OPERATIONAL AIRPORTS



Source: AAI

Rs 4,300 cr. disbursed as Viability Gap Funding (VGF) to airlines to offset losses from capped fares

70 per cent of 371 routes that took off in Udan 1-3 couldn't even last the full three-year VGF period, the CAG found in 2023

So, at Vellore in Tamil Nadu, the terminal stands ready, but the runway still falls short of the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) norms. In Bihar's Raxaul, no airline has shown interest in any of the bidding rounds. The revival of Donakonda in Andhra Pradesh is held up by a land demarcation dispute. Warangal in neighbouring Telangana still awaits navigational aids and the all-important security clearance from the defence ministry.

This when India's aviation story has never looked better. Passenger traffic is hitting new highs—161.3 million people flew on domestic routes in 2024, up 6.1 per cent from the year before. Airlines, too, are in expansion mode: India's commercial fleet has more than doubled over the past decade and is projected to cross 1,200 aircraft by 2030 from 680 today. Yet India's ambitions come undone in the face of many of its smaller airports failing to take off.